

NERINE

a fall-flowering bulb with strap-shaped, semierect, basal leaves. Stout stems bear 10–15 scarlet-red flowers with narrow petals. Useful for cutting. Z10–11
N. undulata Crispa Group, syn. *N. crispa*, illus. p.413. ***Flexuosa Group***, H 16–20in (40–50cm), S 5–6in (12–15cm), is a semievergreen, fall-flowering bulb, with strap-shaped, semierect, basal leaves. Produces 10–20 pink flowers; each petal has a deeper pink mid-vein and a recurved, wavy upper half. Z9–11.
‘Alba’ has white flowers.

NERIUM

APOCYNACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs or small trees, grown for their often large clusters of colorful flowers. Frost tender. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Water potted plants moderately when in full growth, sparingly at other times. Tip prune young plants to promote branching. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. ☉All parts are highly toxic if ingested; contact with the foliage may irritate skin.
N. oleander (Rose bay) illus. p.455. **‘Flavescens Plenum’**, H 6–20ft (2–6m), S 3–10ft (1–3m), is an evergreen, upright, bushy shrub, with leathery, lance-shaped deep green leaves. In summer, bears clusters of salverform, double, pale yellow flowers; Z9–11. **‘Little Red’** has single red flowers; Z6–10. **‘Variegatum’** has leaves with white to pale yellow margins, and double pink flowers. Z10–11

NERTERA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of creeping perennials, grown for their abundant, spherical, beadlike fruits, produced in fall. Excellent for an alpine house. Half hardy. Requires a sheltered, partial shaded position in gritty, moist but well-drained, sandy soil. Resents winter wet. Propagate in spring by seed, division, or tip cuttings.
N. depressa. See *N. granadensis*.
N. granadensis (Bead plant) illus. p.373.

NICANDRA

Apple of Peru, Shoo-fly

SOLANACEAE

Genus of one species of annual producing short-lived flowers and fruiting branches that can be used for dried arrangements. Fully hardy. Requires a position in sun and fertile, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown in spring.
N. physalodes (Apple of Peru, Shoo-fly). Fast-growing, upright, branching annual. H 3ft (90cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has ovate, serrated, mid-green leaves. From summer to early fall, bears a profusion of bell-shaped, white-throated, light violet-blue flowers, more than 1in (2.5cm) across, that last only one day. Flowers are followed by brown berries surrounded by green calyces, 1¼–1½in (3–4cm) across. Thought to repel flies, hence its name. Z7–10

Nicodemia madagascariensis. See *Buddleja madagascariensis*.

NICOTIANA

Tobacco plant

SOLANACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials that are usually grown as annuals, and semievergreen shrubs. Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate annuals and perennials by seed in early spring, shrubs by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. ☉All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested. Contact with the foliage may irritate skin.
N. affinis. See *N. alata*.
N. alata, syn. *N. affinis*, illus. p.231.
N. ‘Baby Bella’. Vigorous, compact, branching perennial, grown as an annual. H 2–2½ft (60–75cm), S to 1ft (30cm). Has oblong-lance-shaped, dark green leaves, to 4in (10cm) long. Bears fragrant, trumpet-shaped, deep red flowers, 1¼–1½in (3–4cm) long. Z10–11
N. glauca. Semievergreen, upright shrub. H and S 8–10ft (2.5–3m). Stout, blue-gray shoots bear narrowly ovate, fleshy, blue-gray leaves. Showy, tubular, bright yellow flowers are produced in summer and early fall. Z9–11
N. langsdorffii illus. p.316.
N. ‘Lime Green’ illus. p.318.
N. x sanderae Cuba Series. Compact branching perennials. H and S 1ft (30cm). Upward-facing, fragrant flowers are white, pink, deep lime green, bright red, or bicolored combining lime green and purple. Z10–11. **Domino Series** illus. p.299. **Sensation Mixed**, H 2–2½ft (60–75cm), is compact, producing fragrant, white, pink, red, purple, and lime green flowers that stay open in the daytime.
N. sylvestris. Branching, short-lived perennial, often grown as a biennnial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 2ft (60cm). Bears panicles of fragrant, tubular, white flowers at the ends of stems in late summer. The sweet flower scent is strongest at night. Has long, rough, mid-green leaves that are sticky to the touch. Prefers sun. Z10–11

NIDULARIUM

BROMELIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming, epiphytic perennials, grown for their overall appearance. Frost tender. Requires a position in partial shade and a rooting medium of equal parts humus-rich soil and sphagnum moss or bark or plastic chips generally used for orchid culture. Using soft water, water moderately during the growing season, sparingly at other times, and keep centers of rosettes filled with water from spring to fall. Propagate by offsets in spring or summer.
N. carolinae. See *Neoregelia carolinae*.
N. fulgens (Blushing bromeliad). Evergreen, spreading, basal-rosetted, epiphytic perennial. H 8in (20cm) or more, S 16–20in (40–50cm). Has dense rosettes of strap-shaped, spiny-toothed, arching, glossy, rich green leaves. Tubular, white-and-purple flowers, almost hidden in a rosette of bright scarlet bracts, are mainly produced in summer. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)
N. innocentii. Evergreen, spreading, basal-rosetted, epiphytic perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has dense

rosettes of strap-shaped, prickle-toothed, arching, dark green, sometimes reddish-green leaves, reddish-purple beneath. Tubular, white flowers, partially hidden in a rosette of bright red bracts, are borne mainly in summer. Z11–12 (min. 54°F/12°C)
N. procerum. Evergreen, spreading, basal-rosetted, epiphytic perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 30in (75cm). Strap-shaped, spiny-toothed, bright green leaves are produced in dense rosettes. Clusters of small, tubular, blue flowers are produced in summer. Z11–12 (min. 54°F/12°C)

NIEREMBERGIA

SOLANACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering perennials, sometimes grown as annuals, and deciduous or semievergreen shrubs. Frost to half hardy. Prefers sun and moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring, by semiripe cuttings in summer, or by seed in fall.
N. caerulea. See *N. linariifolia*.
N. linariifolia, syn. *N. caerulea*, *N. hippomanica*. **‘Purple Robe’** illus. p.312.
N. hippomanica. See *N. linariifolia*.
N. repens, syn. *N. rivularis*, illus. p.361.
N. rivularis. See *N. repens*.

NIGELLA

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of annuals, grown for their attractive flowers, which are suitable for cutting and their ornamental seed pods. Fully hardy. Grows best in sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Deadhead plants to prolong flowering if seed heads are not required. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in spring or early fall.
N. damascena (Devil-in-a-bush, Love-in-a-mist). Fast-growing, upright annual. H 20in (50cm), S 9in (23cm). Has feathery, bright green leaves. Spurred, many-petaled, blue flowers are produced in summer, followed by inflated, rounded, green, then brown seed pods that may be cut and dried. Z9–11. **‘Miss Jekyll’** illus. p.315. **‘Miss Jekyll Alba’** has white flowers with pinkish centers.
Persian Jewels Group illus. p.314.

NOLANA

SOLANACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials, and subshrubs useful for growing in hot, dry sites and rock gardens and as edging. Frost hardy to half hardy. Grow in sun and in fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in spring.
N. atriplicifolia. See *N. paradoxa*.
N. grandiflora. See *N. paradoxa*.
N. paradoxa, syn. *N. atriplicifolia*, *N. grandiflora*. Moderately fast-growing, prostrate annual. H 8–10in (20–25cm), S to 2ft (60cm). Has ovate, mid-green leaves and, in summer, funnel-shaped, purplish-blue flowers, to 2in (5cm) across, that have white-zoned, yellow throats. Z9–11

Nolina recurvata. See *Beaucarnea recurvata*.
Nolina tuberculata. See *Beaucarnea recurvata*.

NOMOCHARIS

LILIACEAE

Genus of bulbs with a lilylike habit and, in summer, loose spikes of flattish flowers, often conspicuously spotted. Fully hardy. Needs partial shade and rich, well-drained soil with a high humus content. Requires moist but not waterlogged soil in summer. Remains dormant throughout winter. Propagate by seed in winter or spring.
N. mairei. See *N. pardanthina*.
N. nana. See *Lilium nanum*.
N. pardanthina, syn. *N. mairei*, illus. p.385.
N. saluenensis. Summer-flowering bulb. H 34in (85cm), S 5–6in (12–15cm). Leafy stems have lance-shaped, scattered leaves. Bears a loose spike of 2–6 saucer-shaped, white or pink flowers, with dark purple eyes and purple spots. Z6–10

Nopalxochia ackermannii. See *Discocactus ackermannii*.

NOTHOFAGUS

Southern beech

NOTHOFAGACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen trees, grown for their habit, foliage, and, in the case of deciduous species, fall color. Has inconspicuous flowers in late spring. Fully to frost hardy. Requires sun or partial shade and, because it is not very resistant to strong winds, should have the shelter of other trees. Prefers deep, fertile, moist but well-drained soil; is not suitable for shallow, chalky soil. Propagate by seed in fall.
N. alpina, syn. *N. procera* (Rauli), illus. p.64.
N. antarctica (Antarctic beech, Nirre). Deciduous, broadly conical tree, sometimes with several main stems. H 50ft (15m), S 30ft (10m). Small, ovate, crinkly-edged, glossy, dark green leaves turn yellow in fall. Z7–10
N. betuloides illus. p.69.
N. dombeyi illus. p.68.
N. menziesii (Silver beech) illus. p.69.
N. obliqua (Robl ) illus. p.63.
N. procera. See *N. alpina*.

NOTHOLIRION

LILIACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering bulbs, related to *Fritillaria* and *Lilium*, grown for their funnel-shaped flowers. Frost hardy to half hardy. Often produces early leaves, which may be damaged by spring frosts, so grow in a cool greenhouse in areas subject to alternating mild and cold periods in spring. Prefers partial shade or full sun and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Bulb dies after flowering. Propagate in spring or fall by offsets, which take 2–3 years to reach flowering size. Alternatively propagate by seed in winter or spring.
N. campanulatum illus. p.386.

Nothopanax. See *Pseudopanax*.
Nothoscordum neriniflorum. See *Allium neriniflorum*.
Notocactus. See *Parodia*.
Notospartium. See *Carmichaelia*.